PART 2 REPORT:RC SKILLSWAP PROTOYPE IMPLEMENTATION

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1. Introduction

This report follows the planning and design phase documented in Part 1 for the RC SkillSwap website. The purpose of this document is to present the functional prototype of the platform and to detail how the principles of interaction design have been practically implemented. This report will showcase the prototype through a series of key screenshots and connect each design decision back to the foundational goals, principles, and guidelines established in the initial research.

2. Adjustments Based on Part 1 Feedback

Based on feedback from Part 1, the following adjustments were incorporated into the prototype design: the "Vouch Counter" was given a more prominent position on user profiles (as seen in Screenshot 2) to build trust more effectively. Additionally, clear tags on the dashboard (Screenshot 1) are used to make requests instantly scannable.

3. The RC SkillSwap Website Prototype

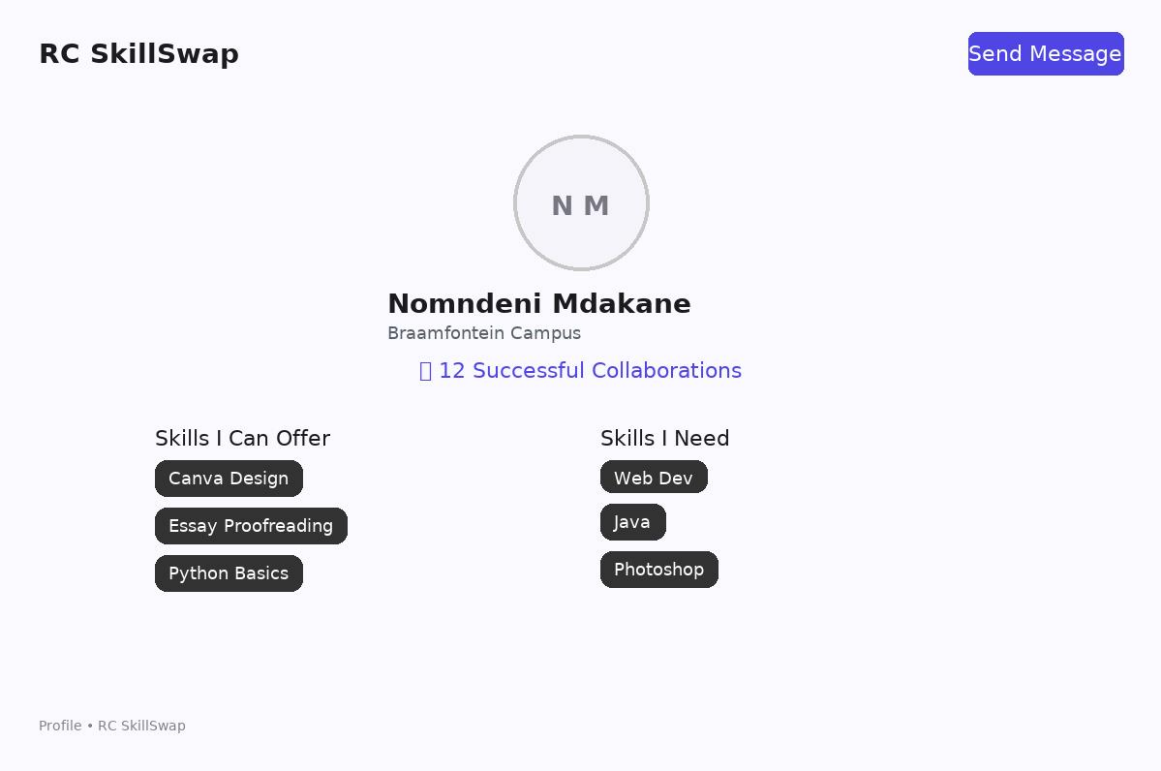
The Dashboard / "Help Request" Board



Description

After a successful login, the user lands on their personal dashboard. This screen acts as their central hub, providing a clear and simple navigation point to all the site's main features. This design ensures the user feels oriented and in control from the very first moment.

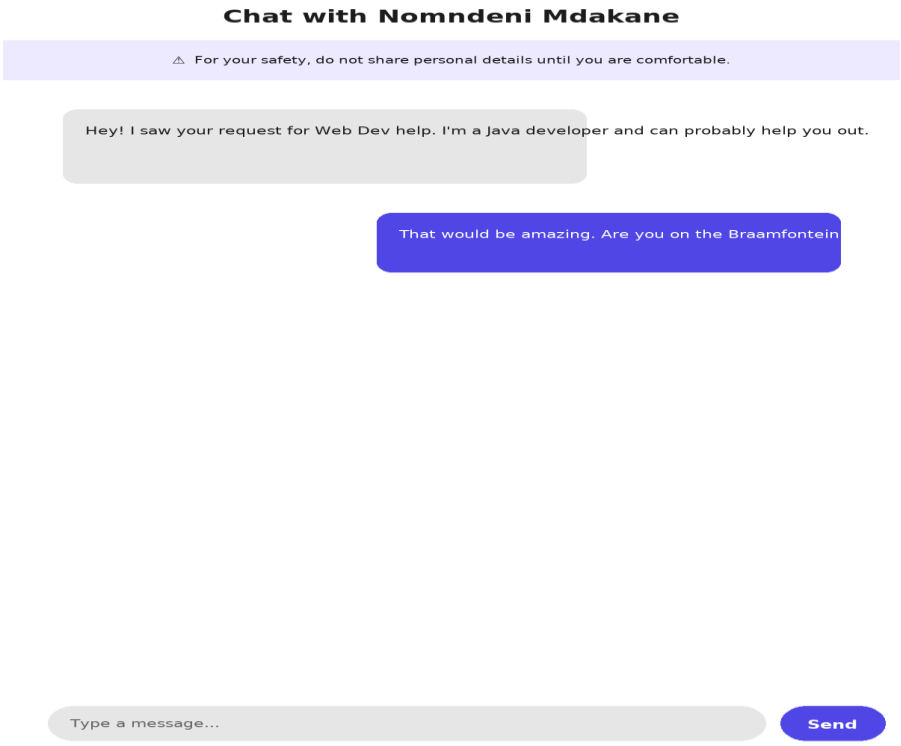
The Student Skill Profile Page



Description

From the dashboard or by clicking on a request, a user can view another student's profile. This screen is designed to quickly build trust and provide key information. The prominent "Successful Collaborations" counter and the clear lists of skills help the user decide if they want to connect.

The Secure Messaging Interface



Description

If the user decides to connect after viewing a profile, clicking "Send Message" opens this private and secure chat interface. The design is intentionally familiar, and the explicit safety warning banner ensures the user feels secure, fulfilling a critical usability goal.

4. Implementation of Interaction Design Concepts

4.1 Usability Goals
The prototype achieves effectiveness, efficiency, and safety through its linear user flows, clear information architecture, and private messaging system. The consistent and familiar layout ensures high learnability and memorability.

4.2 Desirable Aspects of User Experience
The design is credible, and empowering. The "Successful Collaborations" counter builds credibility, while the peer-to-peer framework empowers students and removes the stigma of asking for help.

4.3 Design Principles
The prototype uses clear visibility of system status (e.g., the safety banner in Screenshot 3), consistency in design elements (e.g., buttons and fonts across all screens), and provides users with clear calls-to-action ("Send Message"), all within a simple and aesthetically pleasing interface.

4.4 Interaction Types
The design primarily uses instructing (clicking buttons), conversing (via the messaging system shown in Screenshot 3), and exploring (browsing the dashboard in Screenshot 1) to create a comprehensive user experience.

4.5 Social and Emotional Interaction
The entire platform is a framework for social collaboration, centered on the profile page (Screenshot 2). Emotionally, the design aims to foster confidence and create a sense of relief and mutual respect.

4.6 Web Content Accessibility and Guidelines (WCAG) 2.0
The prototype's design adheres to WCAG 2.0 Level AA guidelines. Text has high contrast against backgrounds, interactive elements are clear, and the site structure is logical.

5. Conclusion

The RC SkillSwap prototype successfully translates the design plan from Part 1 into a tangible, user-focused interface. By integrating established usability goals, design principles, and accessibility standards, the prototype provides a strong foundation for a platform that is functional, engaging, and accessible to all Rosebank College students.

References

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